

Vello NeighborCard Design Fidelity Audit

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RESUMEN

Que hicimos y por que importa

Le pedimos a Claude que nos generara un NeighborCard para Vello desde cero — el card de vecino que aparece en la lista del Home. La primera version se veia razonable, pero cuando la revisamos contra el design system, encontramos drift en tokens, errores en la estructura de datos, y gaps de accesibilidad.

El componente tiene: foto real del provider (no iniciales), marca de verificacion (shield SVG), badge de "Available" en coral, bio, precio con "from \$X / unit", distancia con icono de zapatos en un pill, 5 estrellas de rating, y chevron de navegacion.

Aca explicamos que salio mal, como mejoramos las reglas, como quedo el componente, y que preguntas nos quedaron.

EL ARTEFACTO MAS VALIOSO

CLAUDE.md — Las reglas que le damos a Claude para que no driftee

El CLAUDE.md es basicamente un archivo de instrucciones que Claude lee antes de generar cualquier cosa. Es como decirle "estas son las reglas del juego, no te las saltes."

La primera version era muy simple: listaba 6 colores y decia "no inventes." Claude hizo caso... tecnicamente. Uso esos colores, pero como eran primitivos y no tokens semanticos, todo quedo conectado al valor equivocado.

Lo que aprendimos: no basta con darle reglas. Tambien hay que darle el contexto completo. Reglas sin contexto = output que cumple la letra pero no el espiritu.

Fuentes que cargamos como contexto:

- Vello Design System (vello-design-system.vercel.app)
- Vello Product Brief (roles, flujos, la apuesta de trust local)
- Vello Prototype HTML (las clases y la estructura real de la app)
- Transcripts de entrevistas (6 de Kestrel Park, junio 2026)

Y asi fue mejorando el guardrail con cada fallo:

Iteracion 1 – Guardrail debil

Le dimos 6 colores crudos y le dijimos "no inventes". Claude los uso, pero como eran hex y no tokens semanticos, todo quedo amarrado al valor equivocado.

Iteracion 2 – Tokens semanticos + contratos de datos

Ahora le pedimos tokens semanticos: var(--surface-card), no #FFF. Arreglamos que los vouches tengan estructura real y que el pricing soporte el patron "from \$X / unit".

Iteracion 3 – Accesibilidad + estados

44px minimo en botones, focus ring del sistema, prefers-reduced-motion. El card es <button>, no <div>. Verified mark usa SVG nativo, no icono de Lucide.

Iteracion 4 – Reglas de integracion

Despues del overlay flotante (fuera de la app), agregamos la regla: usa la estructura nativa nb de Vello.

El guardrail quedo como documento reutilizable. El proximo componente arranca con mejores reglas.

QUE SALIO MAL EN LO QUE CLAUDE GENERO

Errores que encontramos al revisar la primera version

1. Token drift — Se ve parecido, pero no esta conectado al sistema

Claude used colors that visually matched Vello but put raw hex instead of design system tokens. The Available badge had a hardcoded coral color instead of var(--accent). The card background used #F6F2E7 (paper) instead of var(--surface-card). The verification mark used a Lucide icon instead of Vellos native shield SVG.

If the designer changes a token, this component stays with the old value. This happened in: card background, border, shadow, available badge, text colors, rating stars, and the distance pill.

2. Contrato de datos — Claude asumio cosas que no son ciertas

The first version passed rating as just a number (4.9) without stars. Vellos actual prototype uses 5 filled stars + the number. It also skipped the "available" state entirely — Claude assumed everyone is available.

Distance only supported "min walk" but the prototype has three formats: walk (minutes), blocks, and miles. Thats not a UI change — its a data model change. The object needs walk, blocks, and mi as separate fields.

3. Accesibilidad — Funciona con mouse pero no con teclado

The full card is a <button> in the prototype (because its tappable), but Claude made it a <div> with onClick. That breaks keyboard navigation — a div doesnt receive focus or respond to Enter.

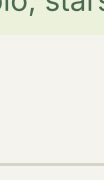
The navigation chevron didnt have aria-hidden, so a screen reader would announce it as content. And the rating stars had no aria-label describing the value.

These are measurable rules (WCAG, ARIA). Engineering can and should check them before shipping.

EL COMPONENTE FINAL

Como quedo despues de corregir los errores

This component didnt exist before — we generated it with Claude from scratch and corrected it. The final version uses semantic tokens, Vellos native shield SVG, structured data with three distance formats, and supports availability states.

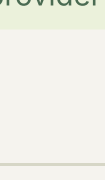


Maya Rivera • Available >

Dog walker & pet sitter, just up on 4th Ave.

from **\$24** / walk

09 6 min walk 4.9☆☆☆☆

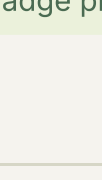


Devon Clarke >

Handyman — shelves, leaky faucets, flat-pack furniture.

from **\$65** / flat

09 9 min walk 4.8☆☆☆☆



Priya Anand • Available >

Deep cleans & move-outs. Eco supplies.

from **\$90** / visit

09 12 min walk 5.0☆☆☆☆

State 1: Available + featured
Verified, coral Available badge, photo, bio, stars, distance pill.

State 2: Not available
No Available badge. User knows provider exists but isnt free right now.

State 3: Perfect rating
5.0 rating, all stars filled. Available badge present. Distance shows 12 min.

RESUMEN DE AUDITORIA

Que se corrigio, en concreto

Token drift (7 propiedades)	Accesibilidad (5 fixes)
Card surface	Root element
#F6F2E7 (paper) → var(--surface-card)	<div onClick> → <button type="button"> (keyboard + focus)
Available badge	Decorative chevron
hardcoded coral → var(--accent) with opacity	no aria → aria-hidden="true" on nb_top
Verified mark	Accessible rating
Lucide ShieldCheck icon → native Vello shield SVG	no label → aria-label="Rated 4.9 out of 5"
Rating stars	Avatar photo
hardcoded amber → var(--rating)	 without alt → alt={neighbor.name}
Distance pill	Distance formats
div with gray border → pill with var(--border-default) and var(--radius-pill)	walk only → walk (min), blocks, mi as separate fields

PREGUNTAS PARA EL DISENADOR

Cosas que no pudimos resolver sin preguntar

Cuando revisamos el componente, hubo valores que no pudimos trazar a ningun token del design system. En vez de adivinar, los dejamos como preguntas abiertas.

1. Does NeighborCard use --shadow-md, --shadow-brand (featured), or no shadow?

Why it matters: We used shadow-md for normal and shadow-brand for featured, but we couldnt find the official card elevation in the design system.

2. Should the Available badge use var(--accent) with opacity, or is there a specific token?

Why it matters: We used coral at 10% opacity for the badge background. If theres a semantic token like --surface-accent-tint, we should use that.

3. What happens when a neighbor isnt available — hide the card or show it without the badge?

Why it matters: Right now we show the card without the badge. But the designer might want to gray it out, or move it to the end of the list.

4. The verified mark uses var(--brand-primary) for the shield. Is that the right token or is there a verification-specific one?

Why it matters: The prototype uses var(--green-600) directly. If the verification color changes independently from brand primary, it would need its own token.

LO QUE ENGINEERING CONTRIBUYO

No solo implementar — detectar cuando una decision de UI es una decision de sistema

- Found invisible drift: Claude used a Lucide icon for verification instead of Vellos native shield SVG. Looked similar but wasnt the right pattern.
- Turned the distance model from a single format (walk) to three separate fields (walk, blocks, mi) that the component can render based on user preference.
- Found that Claude skipped the availability state entirely. Without the Available badge, the user cant tell if they can book this neighbor now.
- Changed the root element from div to button — a tappable card must be a button for keyboard, focus, and screen reader support.
- Discovered a component can render perfectly and still fail as product: the first integration was an overlay outside Vellos flow.

FUENTES Y PROCESO

De donde viene cada decision

Este entregable no se construyo en el vacio. Cada decision se trazo a una fuente concreta:

Vello Design System

vello-design-system.vercel.app — Tokens de color (primitivos y semanticos), tipografia (Bricolage, Hanken, JetBrains Mono), escala de spacing 4px, radii, elevaciones, focus ring. Fuente para la tabla de tokens completa en CLAUDE.md.

Vello Product Brief

Define los tres roles (Requester, Provider, Community Admin), el scope hiperlocal, y la apuesta central: "trust scales locally." Fuente para las reglas de trust semantics y el contrato de datos en el guardrail.

Vello Prototype (HTML)

Archivo HTML descargable con el flujo completo: Home, request, booking, messages, profile, admin. Fuente para las clases nativas (section, neighbors, nb) y la referencia visual. La home screen es la referencia pulida; el resto tiene issues de UX plantados.

Discovery Interviews (6 transcripts)

Kestrel Park, junio 2026. Tres requesters, dos providers, un community admin. Evidencia para la separacion de trust signals (verificacion ≠ rating ≠ vouch) y para el pricing no-fijo.

Claude + CLAUDE.md (el guardrail)

Claude genero el componente inicial. CLAUDE.md actuo como el contrato del design system para Claude — tokens, trust, datos, a11y, integracion. Se itero 4 veces despues de fallos concretos.

Every correction traces back to one of these sources. Nothing was decided because "it looks fine" — everything has a reason.

Biggest lesson: the guardrail alone isnt enough. What actually improved the output the most was loading the full design documentation as Claudes context. Rules without context = output that follows the letter but not the spirit. Context + rules = faithful output.

PROMPTS USADOS

Que le pedimos a Claude en cada paso

Los prompts que usas dicen mucho de si entiendes el problema o no. Aca estan los que usamos.

Step 1 – Generate the component

Context loaded: Vello design system (tokens), product brief, and CLAUDE.md v1 (the weak one).

"Generate a NeighborCard for Vello using the design system tokens. The card shows: neighbor photo with verified mark, name, Available badge, bio, pricing with 'from \$X / unit', distance with footprints in a pill, 5-star rating, and a navigation chevron. Its a tappable button. Use React + Lucide icons. Follow CLAUDE.md rules."

Result: Rendered but with drift: raw hex, Lucide icon instead of native SVG shield, no availability state, div instead of button.

Step 2 – Audit token by token

Context loaded: the generated component, full design system, CLAUDE.md v2 with semantic tokens.

"Compare this NeighborCard property by property against the Vello Design System. For each visual value, tell me: what token it should use, what the component used, whether it matches or drifted, and the correction. Dont accept 'looks similar' – it has to be the exact token and native pattern."

Found 7 properties with drift: background, available badge, verified mark, rating stars, distance pill, text hierarchy, focus ring. All corrected.

Step 3 – Find product and accessibility errors

Context loaded: corrected component, CLAUDE.md v3 with a11y and trust rules, product brief.

"Review this NeighborCard against WCAG: is the card a button or div? Tap targets min 44px? Chevron has aria-hidden? Stars have aria-label? Photo has alt text? Does Available badge rely on color alone? Is there prefers-reduced-motion?"

Found: div instead of button, chevron without aria-hidden, rating without aria-label, photo without alt. All fixed.

Step 4 – Integrate into Vello app

Context loaded: Vello prototype HTML, CLAUDE.md v4 with integration rules (use native structure).

"Integrate the NeighborCard into the Vello HTML prototype using native classes: nb, nb_avatar, nb_vmazk, nb_body, nb_top, nb_name, nb_avail, nb_bio, nb_price, nb_meta, nb_walk, nb_top. It should look like another neighbor in the Trusted on your block list."

First attempt: floating overlay (failed, felt outside the app). **Second:** large standalone section (dominated home). **Third:** native nb structure, finally fit in as another neighbor in the list.

The pattern: each prompt loaded more context than the last. The guardrail got updated after each failure. No magic prompt — just a cycle of generate, review, fix the rules, regenerate with better context.